

The American College of Financial Services

As a part of my ongoing efforts to return to the United States, I interviewed with the American College in August 2012. I accepted an offer to become a professor of retirement income, teaching primarily in the new PhD program on financial and retirement planning, starting in April 2013. The American College was building the Retirement Income Certified Professional (RICP) designation and making the relatively new field of retirement income into a top priority for the future. I believe that my job title at the American College is unique.

Originally created by Solomon Huebner, a University of Pennsylvania professor in the Wharton School who sought to professionalize the life insurance industry, the American College dates back to 1927. The American College created the CLU designation for insurance agents, and for many years most of its students were from the insurance industry. In recent years, the American College has expanded to provide education for all of the financial services profession, though the university still carries an aura of being intertwined with the insurance industry, and certainly many of its students and funding come from the insurance side of financial services profession.

The American College pioneered the RICP designation for financial advisors later in 2012. It provides fair and comprehensive coverage to the different schools of thought and philosophies about retirement income planning, including investments and insurance approaches. I know this because I helped develop the curriculum. The American College is also one of the leading educators for the CFP program, which historically is connected more to the investments and fiduciary side of the ongoing financial services debate. Today, the American College serves both sides of the financial services profession and seeks to provide ongoing leadership in retirement income planning.

McLean Asset Management

In late 2012, I also began a correspondence with Alex Murguia, who is the CEO of McLean Asset Management, headquartered in McLean, Virginia. At